

World Cup 2026 — Advancement & Betting Report

Dated 2026-06-18

24 group matches played; simulation conditioned on actual results

This report summarizes Monte-Carlo advancement probabilities for all 48 teams with 24 group matches already played and fixed into the simulation, alongside the change in those probabilities versus the pre-tournament baseline (same model). Sections 4 and 5 list the actionable Polymarket and sportsbook bets currently flagged by the model. All probabilities are shown as percentages.

Section 1 · Executive Summary

Top title contenders by P(win)

Rank	Team	Grp	P(win)	Δ vs pre-tourn.
1	Argentina	J	17.8%	+1.52%
2	Spain	H	16.1%	-0.48%
3	France	I	11.6%	+0.62%
4	England	L	9.8%	+0.10%
5	Brazil	C	9.7%	-0.55%
6	Colombia	K	5.8%	+0.61%
7	Germany	E	4.5%	-0.20%
8	Portugal	K	4.1%	-0.38%

Biggest movers since pre-tournament

Left: largest absolute change in title odds P(win). Right: largest absolute change in P(reach Round of 16).

Team	P(win)	Δ P(win)	Team	P(R16)	Δ P(R16)
Argentina	17.8%	+1.52%	Australia	53.7%	+16.9%
France	11.6%	+0.62%	Turkey	19.1%	-15.4%
Colombia	5.8%	+0.61%	Paraguay	14.6%	-14.3%
Brazil	9.7%	-0.55%	United States	51.9%	+12.8%
Spain	16.1%	-0.48%	South Korea	50.9%	+11.2%
Portugal	4.1%	-0.38%	Ecuador	38.5%	-11.1%

Argentina leads the field at 17.8% to win the tournament (Group J), ahead of Spain (16.1%) and France (11.6%). The largest title-odds swing belongs to **Argentina** (+1.52% to 17.8%); the largest Round-of-16 swing is **Australia** (+16.9% to 53.7%).

Section 2 · Per-Team Advancement Probabilities

All 48 teams grouped A–L. Within each group, teams are sorted by P(win) descending. Probabilities are the current results-conditioned simulation, shown as percentages.

Team	P(R32)	P(R16)	P(QF)	P(SF)	P(Final)	P(win)	P(Grp 1st)
Mexico (A)	98.9%	60.2%	25.9%	9.9%	3.8%	1.3%	67.1%
South Korea (A)	94.8%	50.9%	19.2%	5.7%	1.9%	0.5%	27.7%
Czech Republic (A)	47.7%	19.4%	7.4%	1.8%	0.5%	0.1%	4.3%
South Africa (A)	24.9%	7.3%	1.6%	0.2%	0.1%	0.0%	0.9%
Switzerland (B)	82.3%	48.2%	22.3%	7.7%	2.7%	0.9%	33.1%
Canada (B)	81.2%	36.2%	11.8%	2.8%	0.7%	0.1%	43.0%
Bosnia and Herzegovina (B)	63.1%	19.4%	4.7%	0.8%	0.1%	0.0%	15.4%
Qatar (B)	39.9%	8.9%	1.5%	0.1%	0.0%	0.0%	8.5%
Brazil (C)	97.5%	68.8%	48.5%	29.9%	17.4%	9.7%	65.5%
Morocco (C)	91.8%	45.7%	24.6%	10.5%	4.5%	1.6%	18.7%
Scotland (C)	83.0%	28.6%	10.3%	2.9%	0.8%	0.2%	15.6%
Haiti (C)	4.6%	0.6%	0.1%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.2%
Australia (D)	94.7%	53.7%	20.6%	7.2%	2.4%	0.6%	38.8%
United States (D)	96.7%	51.9%	19.5%	5.9%	1.9%	0.5%	52.3%
Turkey (D)	42.4%	19.1%	6.4%	2.7%	0.9%	0.3%	5.2%
Paraguay (D)	36.3%	14.6%	4.4%	1.4%	0.4%	0.1%	3.7%
Germany (E)	99.8%	66.3%	33.7%	19.7%	9.6%	4.5%	68.2%
Ecuador (E)	76.5%	38.5%	17.6%	7.0%	2.9%	1.1%	5.0%
Ivory Coast (E)	96.4%	39.9%	11.7%	4.0%	1.1%	0.3%	26.7%
Curaçao (E)	4.9%	0.5%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.1%
Netherlands (F)	91.9%	49.4%	32.5%	16.6%	8.2%	3.8%	51.3%
Japan (F)	84.6%	33.8%	17.6%	7.4%	2.8%	0.9%	21.7%
Sweden (F)	96.0%	29.2%	12.2%	4.0%	1.2%	0.3%	25.9%
Tunisia (F)	10.5%	1.8%	0.4%	0.1%	0.0%	0.0%	1.1%
Belgium (G)	90.2%	61.0%	33.9%	14.3%	6.1%	2.4%	60.1%
Iran (G)	59.9%	30.6%	10.9%	3.6%	1.0%	0.3%	15.8%
Egypt (G)	75.4%	34.2%	10.5%	2.8%	0.7%	0.1%	19.9%
New Zealand (G)	32.2%	9.2%	1.7%	0.3%	0.0%	0.0%	4.3%
Spain (H)	95.8%	70.7%	50.9%	39.8%	26.0%	16.1%	75.0%
Uruguay (H)	75.2%	30.3%	16.3%	8.2%	3.4%	1.3%	15.4%
Saudi Arabia (H)	39.1%	6.5%	1.6%	0.3%	0.1%	0.0%	4.0%
Cape Verde (H)	50.3%	9.3%	2.0%	0.3%	0.1%	0.0%	5.6%
France (I)	99.6%	75.5%	49.7%	34.1%	20.7%	11.6%	79.8%
Norway (I)	97.7%	49.2%	21.5%	9.4%	3.7%	1.4%	18.2%
Senegal (I)	58.3%	23.0%	8.8%	2.9%	0.9%	0.3%	1.5%
Iraq (I)	8.8%	1.6%	0.4%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.4%

Team	P(R32)	P(R16)	P(QF)	P(SF)	P(Final)	P(win)	P(Grp 1st)
Argentina (J)	99.8%	74.6%	60.2%	45.0%	28.6%	17.8%	86.5%
Austria (J)	94.1%	34.9%	16.0%	6.5%	2.2%	0.7%	12.2%
Algeria (J)	54.4%	18.5%	6.7%	2.2%	0.6%	0.2%	0.9%
Jordan (J)	9.3%	2.4%	0.5%	0.1%	0.0%	0.0%	0.4%
Colombia (K)	99.2%	71.1%	45.6%	23.2%	11.7%	5.8%	64.5%
Portugal (K)	85.6%	57.9%	32.2%	17.6%	8.6%	4.1%	29.8%
DR Congo (K)	47.9%	11.6%	2.6%	0.6%	0.1%	0.0%	4.8%
Uzbekistan (K)	26.8%	6.6%	1.7%	0.5%	0.1%	0.0%	0.9%
England (L)	99.6%	76.2%	52.6%	31.4%	17.9%	9.8%	91.9%
Croatia (L)	81.0%	36.8%	15.1%	8.0%	3.1%	1.1%	2.3%
Ghana (L)	67.2%	12.8%	3.2%	0.7%	0.1%	0.0%	4.9%
Panama (L)	12.2%	2.5%	0.7%	0.1%	0.0%	0.0%	0.9%

P(R32) = reach Round of 32 (advance from group); P(Grp 1st) = finish first in group. Knockout probabilities include winning on penalties.

Section 3 · Changes to Advancement Odds vs Pre-Tournament

Delta = current (results-conditioned) minus pre-tournament, same model. Positive (green) means a team's odds improved after the 24 played results; negative (red) means they fell. Sorted by $\Delta P(\text{win})$ descending. Group-stage R32 movement is typically the largest, as actual results lock in qualification scenarios.

Team	Grp	P(R32)	Δ R32	P(R16)	Δ R16	P(win)	Δ win	Δ Grp1st
Argentina	J	99.8%	+1.2%	74.6%	+4.0%	17.8%	+1.52%	+8.2%
France	I	99.6%	+2.9%	75.5%	+2.8%	11.6%	+0.62%	+11.8%
Colombia	K	99.2%	+6.5%	71.1%	+9.1%	5.8%	+0.61%	+23.8%
Norway	I	97.7%	+19.5%	49.2%	+9.8%	1.4%	+0.32%	+0.7%
Austria	J	94.1%	+17.9%	34.9%	+6.8%	0.7%	+0.17%	+0.3%
United States	D	96.7%	+20.1%	51.9%	+12.8%	0.5%	+0.17%	+18.0%
England	L	99.6%	+2.1%	76.2%	+5.7%	9.8%	+0.10%	+20.6%
Algeria	J	54.4%	-12.4%	18.5%	-3.2%	0.2%	+0.04%	-7.4%
Sweden	F	96.0%	+30.9%	29.2%	+9.3%	0.3%	+0.03%	+12.4%
Belgium	G	90.2%	-2.6%	61.0%	-0.8%	2.4%	+0.02%	+2.3%
Australia	D	94.7%	+25.2%	53.7%	+16.9%	0.6%	+0.02%	+14.4%
DR Congo	K	47.9%	+12.6%	11.6%	+2.4%	0.0%	+0.02%	+0.3%
Ghana	L	67.2%	+32.6%	12.8%	+5.7%	0.0%	+0.02%	+1.9%
Morocco	C	91.8%	+4.0%	45.7%	+2.3%	1.6%	+0.01%	-3.4%
Ivory Coast	E	96.4%	+18.2%	39.9%	+6.7%	0.3%	+0.01%	+12.5%
Scotland	C	83.0%	+19.6%	28.6%	+6.5%	0.2%	+0.01%	+8.0%
Czech Republic	A	47.7%	-16.9%	19.4%	-9.7%	0.1%	+0.01%	-10.2%
Saudi Arabia	H	39.1%	+5.4%	6.5%	-0.4%	0.0%	+0.01%	+1.8%
Cape Verde	H	50.3%	+16.4%	9.3%	+3.1%	0.0%	+0.01%	+3.4%
New Zealand	G	32.2%	+1.6%	9.2%	+1.0%	0.0%	+0.01%	+0.1%
South Korea	A	94.8%	+18.5%	50.9%	+11.2%	0.5%	+0.00%	+6.5%
South Africa	A	24.9%	-11.2%	7.3%	-3.4%	0.0%	+0.00%	-4.6%
Uzbekistan	K	26.8%	-11.8%	6.6%	-4.0%	0.0%	+0.00%	-4.5%
Qatar	B	39.9%	+7.6%	8.9%	+1.9%	0.0%	+0.00%	+4.0%
Haiti	C	4.6%	-12.6%	0.6%	-1.7%	0.0%	+0.00%	-0.8%
Curaçao	E	4.9%	-4.8%	0.5%	-0.5%	0.0%	+0.00%	-0.4%
Iran	G	59.9%	-17.9%	30.6%	-7.7%	0.3%	-0.01%	-5.9%
Egypt	G	75.4%	+6.2%	34.2%	+3.5%	0.1%	-0.01%	+3.4%
Bosnia and Herzegovina	B	63.1%	+5.4%	19.4%	+1.2%	0.0%	-0.01%	+4.0%
Jordan	J	9.3%	-12.1%	2.4%	-1.9%	0.0%	-0.01%	-1.1%
Iraq	I	8.8%	-14.4%	1.6%	-3.4%	0.0%	-0.01%	-1.9%
Tunisia	F	10.5%	-21.4%	1.8%	-4.3%	0.0%	-0.01%	-3.4%
Panama	L	12.2%	-27.3%	2.5%	-6.4%	0.0%	-0.01%	-2.5%
Canada	B	81.2%	-5.9%	36.2%	-3.6%	0.1%	-0.05%	+4.3%
Senegal	I	58.3%	-10.5%	23.0%	-5.6%	0.3%	-0.08%	-10.6%

Team	Grp	P(R32)	Δ R32	P(R16)	Δ R16	P(win)	Δ win	Δ Grp1st
Croatia	L	81.0%	-5.7%	36.8%	-5.1%	1.1%	-0.09%	-20.0%
Turkey	D	42.4%	-24.8%	19.1%	-15.4%	0.3%	-0.11%	-16.5%
Japan	F	84.6%	+3.7%	33.8%	+0.3%	0.9%	-0.13%	-4.5%
Uruguay	H	75.2%	-12.4%	30.3%	-6.8%	1.3%	-0.15%	-3.7%
Paraguay	D	36.3%	-26.2%	14.6%	-14.3%	0.1%	-0.16%	-15.8%
Germany	E	99.8%	+2.4%	66.3%	+0.4%	4.5%	-0.20%	+8.4%
Switzerland	B	82.3%	-9.6%	48.2%	-7.1%	0.9%	-0.26%	-12.3%
Mexico	A	98.9%	+6.0%	60.2%	+2.5%	1.3%	-0.29%	+8.4%
Ecuador	E	76.5%	-14.3%	38.5%	-11.1%	1.1%	-0.34%	-20.5%
Portugal	K	85.6%	-7.7%	57.9%	-4.9%	4.1%	-0.38%	-19.7%
Netherlands	F	91.9%	-0.6%	49.4%	-1.7%	3.8%	-0.38%	-4.6%
Spain	H	95.8%	-3.1%	70.7%	-1.9%	16.1%	-0.48%	-1.4%
Brazil	C	97.5%	-0.4%	68.8%	-1.1%	9.7%	-0.55%	-3.8%

Biggest R16 gainers: Australia (+16.9%), United States (+12.8%), South Korea (+11.2%). **Biggest R16 drops:** Turkey (-15.4%), Paraguay (-14.3%), Ecuador (-11.1%).

The 24 played group results that drove these changes

Match	Score	Match	Score
Mexico v South Africa	2–0	Belgium v Egypt	1–1
South Korea v Czech Republic	2–1	Iran v New Zealand	2–2
Canada v Bosnia and Herzegovina	1–1	Spain v Cape Verde	0–0
United States v Paraguay	4–1	Saudi Arabia v Uruguay	1–1
Qatar v Switzerland	1–1	France v Senegal	3–1
Brazil v Morocco	1–1	Iraq v Norway	1–4
Haiti v Scotland	0–1	Argentina v Algeria	3–0
Australia v Turkey	2–0	Austria v Jordan	3–1
Germany v Curaçao	7–1	Portugal v DR Congo	1–1
Ivory Coast v Ecuador	1–0	Uzbekistan v Colombia	1–3
Netherlands v Japan	2–2	England v Croatia	4–2
Sweden v Tunisia	5–1	Ghana v Panama	1–0

Section 4 · Actionable Polymarket Bets

Top fee-adjusted edges from the tournament-advancement simulation (20,000 sims, seed 42) versus live Polymarket advancement and group-winner markets. Edges are fee-adjusted and sized quarter-Kelly on the \$1,310 pool (5% per-bet cap). Source: advancement_edges.md — top-edges table.

#	Team	Market	Side	Sim P	PM price	Fee	Fee-adj edge	Stake (\$)
1	Iran	Reach R32 (knockout)	YES	59.9%	0.413	0.007	+17.8%	65.50
2	Australia	Win Group D	YES	38.8%	0.216	0.005	+16.7%	65.50
3	United States	Win Group D	NO	47.7%	0.310	0.006	+16.1%	65.50
4	United States	Reach Quarterfinals	NO	80.5%	0.640	0.007	+15.8%	65.50
5	Iran	Reach Round of 16	YES	30.6%	0.150	0.004	+15.2%	58.70
6	Colombia	Reach Quarterfinals	YES	45.6%	0.300	0.006	+15.0%	65.50
7	Colombia	Win Group K	YES	64.6%	0.490	0.007	+14.8%	65.50
8	Portugal	Win Group K	NO	70.2%	0.560	0.007	+13.4%	65.50
9	Colombia	Reach Round of 16	YES	71.1%	0.570	0.007	+13.3%	65.50
10	Switzerland	Win Group B	NO	66.9%	0.530	0.007	+13.1%	65.50
11	Australia	Reach Round of 16	YES	53.7%	0.400	0.007	+13.0%	65.50
12	Qatar	Reach R32 (knockout)	YES	39.9%	0.270	0.006	+12.3%	55.63
13	Portugal	Reach Quarterfinals	NO	67.8%	0.550	0.007	+12.0%	65.50
14	France	Reach Quarterfinals	NO	50.3%	0.380	0.007	+11.6%	61.76
15	Portugal	Reach Round of 16	NO	42.2%	0.300	0.006	+11.5%	54.41
16	United States	Reach Round of 16	NO	48.1%	0.360	0.007	+11.4%	59.12
17	Portugal	Reach Semifinals	NO	82.4%	0.710	0.006	+10.8%	65.50
18	Morocco	Win Group C	NO	81.3%	0.700	0.006	+10.7%	65.50
19	France	Reach Semifinals	NO	65.9%	0.550	0.007	+10.2%	65.50
20	United States	Reach Semifinals	NO	94.1%	0.840	0.004	+9.7%	65.50

Side = the wager the simulation favours (YES buy at best ask; NO buy at 1 – YES bid). Fee-adj edge = sim probability – buy price – per-share taker fee $0.03 \cdot p \cdot (1-p)$. Coverage: 468 Polymarket events pulled; 336 team-stage markets matched. Full ranked list of all matched markets is in docs/research/advancement_edges.md.

Section 5 · Actionable Sportsbook Bets

Current sportsbook bet card (model edge vs market). Source: data/card_latest.md, generated 2026-06-18T09:50:49. Pool: rung 0 £1500, Kelly fraction 0.25.

#	Match	Selection	Odds	Venue	Model %	Mkt %	Edge	Stake
1	Canada vs Qatar	Qatar	13.50	matchbook	9.7%	7.5%	+31.6%	9.48
2	Mexico vs South Korea	Mexico	2.12	betfair_ex_uk	51.7%	46.7%	+9.6%	32.22
3	Canada vs Qatar	Draw	6.00	betfair_ex_uk	17.5%	16.5%	+5.1%	3.85
4	Czech Republic vs South Africa	South Africa	4.90	betfair_ex_uk	20.9%	21.0%	+2.3%	2.18
5	Switzerland vs Bosnia and Herzegovina	Bosnia and Herzegovina	7.00	betfair_ex_uk	14.6%	14.2%	+2.0%	1.27

Odds are decimal best-available at the listed venue. Edge = model probability vs de-vigged market probability. Stakes in £ (pool currency). The card also carries model scoreline / O-U / BTTS markets for the four listed fixtures (see source file).

Model component breakdown (per pick)

Pick	Elo	Dixon-Coles	Blended model
Qatar (v Canada)	7%	17%	9.7%
Mexico (v South Korea)	60%	53%	51.7%
Draw (Canada v Qatar)	14%	23%	17.5%
South Africa (v Czech Rep.)	22%	20%	20.9%
Bosnia & H. (v Switzerland)	11%	19%	14.6%

Methodology & Caveats

- **Knockout probabilities are noisier.** Every simulated match is driven by a straight 50/50 average of the Elo and Dixon-Coles 1X2 probabilities — there is **no market term**. No odds exist for the later rounds, so a market-anchored blend is impossible; these are an independent, noisier model view, not ground truth.
- **Advancement includes penalties.** A 90-minute knockout draw is resolved by the simulator's extra-time / penalty model, so 'reaching' a stage **includes** winning on penalties — matching Polymarket resolution ('reach stage X' = the team is in stage X, however it got there).
- **Host advantage.** The three hosts (United States, Mexico, Canada) get the home-advantage bonus on their own group fixtures; every other group match and all knockout matches are neutral.
- **Polymarket sizing.** Edges are fee-adjusted (per-share taker fee 0.03·p·(1–p) subtracted) and sized quarter-Kelly on the \$1,310 pool with a 5% per-bet cap; the simulation ran 20,000 iterations (seed 42).
- **Delta convention.** All Δ columns are current (results-conditioned, 24 matches fixed) minus the pre-tournament baseline from the same model.
- **Not financial advice.** Figures are model outputs for research only. Every probability and odds figure in this report is traceable to the four source data files.

Sources: data/advancement_current_vs_pretournament.csv · data/advancement_played_results.json · docs/research/advancement_edges.md · data/card_latest.md